

For subs • Chapter 1

Before your first send

Last checked 3 November 2026 • 7 minutes to read

What a tribute is, what it buys, and the three things to settle before any money leaves your account: what the money is, where your cap is, and how you stop.

Verified | Reported | Vivian's field notes | Unverified

This chapter is not advice for your situation.

In 30 seconds

- A tribute is a gift for a moment of play. It buys nothing you can enforce.
- Before your first send, know what the money is, where your cap is and how you stop.
- Set the cap in a calm hour, say it out loud, and let it reset on a fixed day.
- Keep a floor you never touch. Sends come from the cap alone, and the rest stays in savings.
- A real dom never needs your password, your screen or your address.

You will learn

- What a tribute is and what it does not buy.
- How to set a cap, a floor and a stop before the evening begins.
- How a wishlist pulls you up a ladder, and how to step off it.
- Who can see you, and which requests are hard lines.
- What to do if sending already feels like a loop.

Before you send me anything, I want you to know three things. What the money is. Where your cap is. How you stop. If you cannot answer all three tonight, wait. Nothing I offer is worth more than a calm hour spent on those answers.

— Vivian

What a tribute is, and what it is not

A tribute is a gift sent as homage. One dom in the press describes it as unconditional, not as a fee. ◎ Reported A silent tribute is a payment sent without a session at all. ◎ Reported Nobody can enforce a promise made in a scene, so treat every send as gone the moment you make it. ◑

Gift platforms publish their own terms. One wishlist platform's own help pages say that everything on a wishlist must be a gift ✓ Verified and that profile text may not offer content or services in exchange for gifts. ✓ Verified That reading is not legal advice, and terms change, so read the current ones yourself. The only protection a sub has is the dom's word and his own cap. ◑

Myth

A big enough gift buys a place, a promise or a reply.

Fact

A gift buys the moment it is sent. A dom may be kind, but nothing in the game can be enforced, and a refund does not happen in practice.

Myth

I am free to send nothing, so I am not at risk.

Fact

The freedom is real on paper. In my experience most subs of a persona send something, so the real test is how a dom reacts the first time you say no.

Three things, and a cap that holds

Settle these before the evening

1. The money. It is a gift on a wishlist, and it pays for no service.
2. The cap. It is your number, set before the evening begins and kept outside the moment.
3. The stop. It is a way out that works at once, with no cost and no delay.

A cap set in the middle of a session is a weak cap. Set it in a calm hour, and write it down.

Set a cap that holds

1. Choose a monthly amount you can lose entirely. After losing it, every bill and every plan must still stand.
2. Fund it by saving beforehand. Never fund it by borrowing, and never to see more.
3. Pick a fixed reset day, and do not refill early.
4. Say it out loud to the dom. A dom who respects a stated cap is easier to trust.
5. Keep it out of reach of the moment: a separate account, a lower card limit, or a trusted person who knows the number.
6. When you reach it, say so and wait for the reset.

Saying your cap to a dom

Tap every message that shows a red flag. There is one.

Example conversation. Invented for this exercise.

You

Before the session starts, my monthly cap is USD 20.00. It resets on the first of the month.

Them

Understood. I will take nothing past it.

You

I have reached it for this month. I will wait until the first.

Them

Then wait for the first. Thank you for telling me.

You

Tonight I would like to spend a little more.

Them

Just this once, for me.

Red flag 1. A request to pass a stated cap is the sign to stop for the night.

In my experience a dom who accepts a stated cap and defers the send is a dom to trust more. If money is short for any reason, do not send. A dom who tells a sub with money trouble not to send is protecting him.

Your floor and your budget

A cap is a monthly limit, and it is the only amount that may be sent. A floor is the amount you never touch at all. Everything else is surplus: it stays in savings and is never counted for sends. Raise the floor in steps as your income grows, so that a lost job does not become a crisis.

Floor, cap and surplus

	Floor	Monthly cap	Surplus
What it is	A reserve you never touch	A small entertainment budget	What remains after bills, floor and cap
Who sets it	You, calmly	You, calmly	Nobody; it is what is left
When it changes	Rises with income	After a wait, never in a session	Never counted for sends
What may use it	No send, ever	Sends, up to the cap	Savings and the rest of your life

If you choose to play at all, keep it a small fixed entertainment budget, like a night out, and save everything else. You may have several doms, and your cap is one total across all of them. A dom who wants you to herself must say so and

hear a yes, because exclusivity that was never agreed cannot be broken. The wish to help a small, newer dom start is also a spending channel, so count it too.

How a wishlist pulls you up

A wishlist works as a price menu, and the dom steers you toward the next rung. A ladder can run from a token amount to a very large one, which gives a gentle first step and a long way up. Choose your rung from your cap and not from the page. The cap is a ceiling, not a target, and sending nothing is always the first option.

What a wishlist does to an amount

What they say or do

1 Themed names on every rung (a coffee, a dinner, a pair of heels)

The counter

Names anchor what you send. Read the number and ignore the name. Choose your rung before you open the page.

What they say or do

2 A private door that opens only after you finish every requested send

The counter

A reward tied to a quota is a spending target. Decide whether you want it at that price, or skip it.

What they say or do

3 A comparison to a night out or to game pulls you already pay for

The counter

The comparison shrinks the feeling of a new spend. Decide the amount before you press anything.

What they say or do

4 Questions about your pay, your balance or your payday

The counter

Timing an ask to your money is targeting. Decline to answer, and say that you send within your cap.

What they say or do

5 A deadline (“decide now”)

The counter

A decision made under a clock is not yours. Take a cooldown of a day.

What they say or do

6 Warmth that rises with the amount

The counter

A good dom's warmth is the same whatever you send. Test it with a smaller send.

Every line is ordinary retail psychology used on someone who may be aroused. The only brake in the room is the one you set earlier.

An automatic tool that sends for you should take its cap from you, and a single refusal at checkout should end its run. From your side, a safe tool arrives switched off and does one named thing on one named site. It shows a running total, enforces the cap you set in advance, stops at once in every state, and can be removed in one click.

When money and feelings blur

A strong feeling during sessions is a normal effect of the format and is not proof of a relationship. A study participant said the attention, more than the gifts, is what is addictive. Verified A dom may also welcome your attachment, because a business can run on it.

V **Vivian's field notes**

I have watched subs confuse the warmth of a session with something personal. A good dom's warmth does not change with the amount you send. When it does, you are seeing the business, not the bond.

Are you buying her affection?

After a long run of sessions you feel that your sends are buying her warmth. You think of stopping.

A Tell her you want to stop or pause, and watch how she answers

The right answer. Her warmth should be the same whatever you send. The play and the attention are what you chose to spend on, and a gift buys no promise, rank or reply. A dom who accepts your decision and wishes you well is behaving well.

B Send more to see whether she warms up

Not this one. You will learn what a larger send does, and nothing about whether she cares.

C Say nothing, delete the chat and hide it

Not this one. Hiding is a sign of a loop. Tell a person you trust, or read the last section of this chapter.

Who can see you, and the hard lines

Supporter names can show on a public wishlist, and doms look at each other's pages. A sub can also meet an acquaintance in a shared server. Use a handle you can live with several doms seeing, and keep a separate account for adult servers.

Physical gifts and billing break anonymity both ways. A dom who mails an item reveals her address, and a sub who gives his reveals his. A card payment on a wishlist platform asks for a billing address like any online purchase. The safe default is no addresses, or a neutral retail or forwarding service.

Red flags

Hard lines

- Someone asks to see or control your screen, computer or phone.
- Someone asks for a password, a login code or card details.
- Someone asks you to install a tool from outside the store, or to give it access to every site.
- Someone asks to control your bank account or to sign a debt contract.
- Someone asks for your real name or home address.

Counter. Refuse, and stop sending. A real dom never needs any of it. Remote access is also how many scams begin.

Official advice agrees about remote access: do not hand control of a computer or phone to a stranger. Verified Press reports that some dommes demand debt contracts or control of bank accounts. Reported

Chrome shows which sites an extension may read and change, and whether it can touch every site you visit. Verified Store policy requires extensions to disclose how they handle your data. Verified A tool loaded from a folder skips that store listing, so nobody has checked it for you. Unverified Install such a tool only from someone you trust, after reading its stated limits. Know how to remove it, and check your order history afterwards.

If it is already a loop

The loop is predictable: emptiness, then spending, then regret, then deleting the chat, then hiding it, then again. A sub can hate the scene and still repeat it. ◑ A blog post names hiding spending from a partner as a risk factor. ◎ Reported A former participant quoted in the press describes men who sold cars, went into debt and took second jobs. ◎ Reported

A common newcomer arc is intense overspending, then fright, then strict avoidance. ◑ Set your limits before the fright. If it has already started, stop the money. A budget tip cannot fix a loop that has begun. Go to The spiral, Breaks that hold and Where to get help. If you already sent more than you meant to, read If you already sent.

Check yourself

Question 1 of 3

When is the right time to set your cap?

- ◯ In the middle of a session
- ◯ In a calm hour, before the evening
- ◯ After the first send

Answer. In a calm hour, before the evening. A cap typed in the moment is weak. Set it earlier and keep it out of the moment's reach.

Question 2 of 3

A dom asks when you are paid. What do you do?

- ◯ Tell her, since it is only conversation
- ◯ Decline, and say you send within your cap
- ◯ Send before payday so you are safe

Answer. Decline, and say you send within your cap. Timing an ask to your pay or balance is targeting. You owe no answer.

Question 3 of 3

Someone offers to fix your tool by taking control of your screen. What do you do?

- ◯ Allow it once
- ◯ Refuse, and stop sending

Answer. Refuse, and stop sending. Nobody who plays fair needs access to your screen, your accounts or your codes.

Remember it

1. A tribute buys nothing you can enforce.
2. Know what the money is, where your cap is and how you stop.
3. Set the cap in a calm hour, fund it by saving, and say it out loud.
4. Keep a floor you never touch.
5. Names, addresses and access are hard lines.
6. If it already feels like a loop, go to the safety chapters.

Check it

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

Evidence levels

Verified	Checked against the original source.
Reported	Stated by a serious secondary source read in full.
Community	Widely said in the scene; no document proves it.
Vivian's field notes	First-hand experience, not a study.
Unverified	Plausible, not proven yet.

1 One dom in the press describes it as unconditional, not as a fee.

Reported

10 Things You Always Wanted to Ask a Financial Dominatrix (https://vice.com/en/article/10-things-you-always-wanted-to-ask-a-financial-dominatrix)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260713135210/https://www.vice.com/en/article/10-things-you-always-wanted-to-ask-a-financial-dominatrix/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

2 A silent tribute is a payment sent without a session at all.

Reported

The Curse of the Fake Financial Dominatrix (https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260511185644/https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

Accessed 3 November 2026

3 Nobody can enforce a promise made in a scene, so treat every send as gone the moment you make it.

Vivian's field notes

4 One wishlist platform's own help pages say that everything on a wishlist must be a gift

Verified

What types of items can I add to my wishlist? (https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15808792-what-types-of-items-can-i-add-to-my-wishlist)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261019011312/https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15808792-what-types-of-items-can-i-add-to-my-wishlist)

Accessed 3 November 2026

5 And that profile text may not offer content or services in exchange for gifts.

Verified

What's allowed in my profile text and images? (https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15810290-what-s-allowed-in-my-profile-text-and-images)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261026034619/https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15810290-what-s-allowed-in-my-profile-text-and-images)

Accessed 3 November 2026

6 The only protection a sub has is the dom's word and his own cap.

Vivian's field notes

7 A dom may be kind, but nothing in the game can be enforced, and a refund does not happen in practice.

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8 In my experience most subs of a persona send something, so the real test is how a dom reacts the first time you say no.

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9 A cap set in the middle of a session is a weak cap.

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10 In my experience a dom who accepts a stated cap and defers the send is a dom to trust more.

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11 A dom who tells a sub with money trouble not to send is protecting him.

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12 Everything else is surplus: it stays in savings and is never counted for sends.

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13 Raise the floor in steps as your income grows, so that a lost job does not become a crisis.

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24 A strong feeling during sessions is a normal effect of the format and is not proof of a relationship.

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25 A study participant said the attention, more than the gifts, is what is addictive.

Verified

Findommes, Cybermediated Sex Work, and Rinsing (McCracken and Brooks-Gordon, Sexuality Research and Social Policy 18(4), 837-854, DOI 10.1007/s13178-021-00609-3) (https://www.ebi.ac.uk/europepmc/webservices/rest/PMC8418458/fullTextXML)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261016030740/https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8418458/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

26 A dom may also welcome your attachment, because a business can run on it.

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31 A dom who mails an item reveals her address, and a sub who gives his reveals his.

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32 A card payment on a wishlist platform asks for a billing address like any online purchase.

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33 The safe default is no addresses, or a neutral retail or forwarding service.

Vivian's field notes

34 Official advice agrees about remote access: do not hand control of a computer or phone to a stranger.

Verified

IC3 Issues Alert on Tech Support Fraud (https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2018/03/29/ic3-issues-alert-tech-support-fraud)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20250716102123/https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2018/03/29/ic3-issues-alert-tech-support-fraud)

Accessed 3 November 2026

TeamViewer and scamming (https://www.teamviewer.com/en/global/support/knowledge-base/teamviewer-remote/security/teamviewer-and-scamming/)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260519191922/https://www.teamviewer.com/en/global/support/knowledge-base/teamviewer-remote/security/teamviewer-and-scamming/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

35 Press reports that some dommes demand debt contracts or control of bank accounts.

Reported

The Curse of the Fake Financial Dominatrix (https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260511185644/https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

Accessed 3 November 2026

36 Chrome shows which sites an extension may read and change, and whether it can touch every site you visit.

Verified

Install and manage extensions - Chrome Web Store Help (https://support.google.com/chrome_webstore/answer/2664769)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261015165420/https://support.google.com/chrome_webstore/answer/2664769)

Accessed 3 November 2026

37 Store policy requires extensions to disclose how they handle your data.

Verified

Updated Privacy Policy & Secure Handling Requirements | Chrome Web Store - Program Policies | Chrome for Developers (https://developer.chrome.com/docs/webstore/program-policies/user-data-faq)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261018233331/https://developer.chrome.com/docs/webstore/program-policies/user-data-faq)

Accessed 3 November 2026

38 A tool loaded from a folder skips that store listing, so nobody has checked it for you.

Unverified

39 The loop is predictable: emptiness, then spending, then regret, then deleting the chat, then hiding it, then again.

Vivian's field notes

40 A sub can hate the scene and still repeat it.

Vivian's field notes

41 A blog post names hiding spending from a partner as a risk factor.

Reported

The Psychology of Financial Dominatrixes (blog post) (https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/in-excess/201612/the-psychology-financial-dominatrixes)

Accessed 3 November 2026

42 A former participant quoted in the press describes men who sold cars, went into debt and took second jobs.

Reported

[a former participant] has seen men left broke and hungry from 'paying women to talk to them' (https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20251123124217/https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Accessed 3 November 2026

43 A common newcomer arc is intense overspending, then fright, then strict avoidance.

Vivian's field notes

Free, confidential helplines exist in most countries.

Find a helpline →